THE FUN PART

The Challenge

Your shot at an internship — or a full-time role.

This isn't a fake exercise or a marketing gimmick. We are actively hiring. The best submissions from this challenge will lead to real conversations with me and my team — and real job offers.

I'd rather hire someone who showed me what they can build than someone who just has a polished resume.

THE CHALLENGE

The Brief

Your goal is to propose and prototype a new AI-powered product (an "AI Pod") for one of the companies in Fluent's portfolio. Here's how:

1. **Pick a company** from Fluent's portfolio → browse them at fluentsoftwaregroup.com/portfolio. Choose one that interests you.
2. **Research it deeply** — what does the company do? Who are its users? What industry problems exist? Where are the inefficiencies and pain points?
3. **Propose an AI Pod** — design a concept for an AI-powered feature, tool, or product that could be built for that company. Think about what problem it solves and why AI is the right approach.
4. **Build an MVP** — it doesn't have to be production-ready. A working prototype, a proof of concept, a demo, or even a detailed technical architecture with mockups all work.
5. **Submit your proposal** — a short deck or document covering your thinking, your approach, and what you built.

Your submission should include:

- The company you chose and why you picked it
- The problem or opportunity you identified
- Your proposed AI solution — what it does and who it's for
- Technical approach — architecture, models, stack, and key design decisions
- Your MVP, demo, or prototype — show us what you built or designed

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Send to hr@usemarea.com: a PDF document covering the above, plus a short (~5 min) video walking us through everything — in an easily watchable format (YouTube link, Loom, Google Drive, etc.)

THE CHALLENGE

What we're looking for

We're evaluating signal, not polish. A rough but clever MVP beats a pretty but shallow deck every time.

Product Thinking

Can you identify a real problem worth solving and scope a practical, focused solution? We want to see that you understand users, not just technology.

Technical Chops

Does your technical approach make sense? Is it buildable? We care more about your reasoning and architecture decisions than whether the code is perfect.

Creativity

Surprise us. The best ideas probably aren't the obvious ones. We want to see how you think differently about problems and come up with unexpected solutions.

Communication

Can you explain your thinking clearly — both the technical decisions and the product rationale? Being able to communicate your ideas is just as important as having them.

Timeline: Due Friday March 27th 11:59 PM. Reviewing on rolling basis. **Team size:** Solo **Submit to:** hr@usemarea.com

THE CHALLENGE

Starter ideas (just to get the wheels turning)

You're not limited to these — they're just seeds. The best submissions will be ideas we haven't thought of.

Smart Scheduling

An AI optimizer for a dental PMS that predicts no-shows, auto-fills cancellations, and suggests optimal appointment slots based on procedure type and patient history.

Revenue Copilot

A dynamic pricing assistant for a hotel management platform that analyzes demand signals, competitor rates, and seasonal patterns to recommend room pricing in real-time.

Data Migration Bot

An automated tool that helps onboard new customers by intelligently migrating and mapping legacy data from old systems into a modern platform — reducing onboarding from weeks to hours.

> *These are starting points, not boundaries. Dig into a company, find a real pain point, and build something that solves it. The most impressive submissions are always the ones we didn't expect.*

NEXT STEPS

From submission to offer

Here's exactly what happens after today.

1. **Submit your proposal** by Friday March 27th 11:59 PM — deck, doc, repo, whatever format works best for your submission
2. **We review every single submission.** Top candidates get invited for a conversation with me and the team — not a whiteboard grilling or a trick-question interview, an actual conversation about your work and your thinking
3. **Best candidates to be engaged** for internships or full-time roles at Marea or elsewhere within the Fluent portfolio, depending on fit and interest

One more thing: **ask questions.** Seriously. Emailing us with smart questions about the challenge, the companies, or the tech is a good sign — not a bother. It shows you're engaged and thinking critically.

ROLES WE'RE HIRING

AI Internship Roles

These are the positions we're actively looking to fill. Each one plays a critical role in how we build and grow.

AI Support Engineer

Own our support AI agent end-to-end — build automation flows from real ticket data, prompt-engineer and tune agent responses, and manage our Knowledge Base as a living system agents learn from. You'll work real support tickets yourself to build product knowledge, then turn what you learn into workflows an agent can handle next time. Success = less human intervention.

AI Engineer

Build and ship AI-native product features on a real commerce platform — not demos. Design agentic workflows in Java/Spring Boot, implement tool-use and RAG-based retrieval, and own features through monitoring, evaluation, and iteration. Work closely with PM and UX to turn customer pain points into autonomous product capabilities.

Revenue Growth / GTM Engineer

Build the systems that generate pipeline and drive revenue — GTM as an engineering problem. Design automated outbound campaigns, deploy AI tools to personalize and qualify at scale, own funnel analytics, and optimize the full sales tech stack (HubSpot, Clay, Outreach, etc.). If your instinct is to automate and measure everything, this is for you.

These aren't hypothetical roles. We're actively hiring for each of these positions. Your challenge submission is your application — show us what you can do.

LINKS & RESOURCES

Everything you need

- **Valsoft** — valsoftcorp.com
- **Fluent** — fluentsoftwaregroup.com
- **Browse Fluent companies** — fluentsoftwaregroup.com/portfolio
- **Marea** — usemarea.com
- **Submit to** — hr@usemarea.com
- **Deadline** — Friday, March 27th at 11:59 PM
- **My contact** — www.linkedin.com/in/anthony-mirarchi

Q&A

Ask me anything.

The company, the tech, the challenge, my career, salary, what the day-to-day is really like — whatever you want to know.